CREATION & PATRIARCHS

Creation of the World

In the Beginning

God creates heaven and earth in six days and rests on the seventh. He makes humanity in His own image.

Genesis 1–2

CREATION & PATRIARCHS

The Fall of Adam and Eve

In the Beginning

Adam and Eve disobey God and eat the forbidden fruit. Sin and death enter the world, but God promises a Savior.

Genesis 3

CREATION & PATRIARCHS

Cain and Abel

In the Beginning

Abel offers a pleasing sacrifice to God. Cain, jealous, murders his brother — the first sin of violence.

Genesis 4:1–16

CREATION & PATRIARCHS

Noah and the Great Flood

c. 3000 BC

God sends a flood to cleanse the earth. Noah's family and the animals are saved in the ark. God sets a rainbow as His covenant sign.

Genesis 6–9

CREATION & PATRIARCHS

The Tower of Babel

After the Flood

Humanity builds a tower to reach heaven through their own power. God confuses their languages and scatters them.

Genesis 11:1–9

CREATION & PATRIARCHS

God Calls Abraham

c. 2000 BC

God calls Abram to leave his homeland and promises to make him the father of a great nation through whom all peoples will be blessed.

Genesis 12:1–3

CREATION & PATRIARCHS

The Binding of Isaac

c. 2000 BC

God tests Abraham by asking him to sacrifice Isaac. Abraham obeys, and God provides a ram — prefiguring Christ's sacrifice on the Cross.

CREATION & PATRIARCHS

Jacob's Ladder

c. 1900 BC

Jacob dreams of a ladder reaching heaven with angels ascending and descending. God renews the covenant promise. The Fathers see this as an image of the Theotokos.

CREATION & PATRIARCHS

Joseph Sold into Egypt

c. 1880 BC

Joseph's brothers sell him into slavery, but God turns evil to good. Joseph rises to save Egypt and his family from famine.

Genesis 22:1–14

Genesis 28:10–17

Genesis 37; 41–45

CREATION & PATRIARCHS

Israel in Egypt

c. 1870 BC

Jacob's family settles in Egypt. Over centuries they multiply into a great nation, but a new Pharaoh enslaves them.

Genesis 46; Exodus 1

EXODUS & CONQUEST

The Birth of Moses

c. 1530 BC

Pharaoh orders all Hebrew boys killed. Moses' mother places him in a basket on the Nile. Pharaoh's daughter rescues him.

Exodus 2:1–10

EXODUS & CONQUEST

The Burning Bush

c. 1450 BC

God appears to Moses in a bush that burns but is not consumed and reveals His name: I AM WHO I AM. The Fathers see the bush as an image of the Theotokos.

Exodus 3:1–15

EXODUS & CONQUEST

The Ten Plagues

c. 1450 BC

God sends ten plagues on Egypt to free His people. The final plague — the death of the firstborn — brings Pharaoh to release Israel.

Exodus 7–11

EXODUS & CONQUEST

The First Passover

c. 1450 BC

Israel marks their doorposts with lamb's blood and the angel of death passes over. The Passover lamb prefigures Christ, the Lamb of God.

Exodus 12

EXODUS & CONQUEST

Crossing the Red Sea

c. 1450 BC

God parts the Red Sea and Israel walks through on dry ground. Pharaoh's army is destroyed. The Church Fathers see this as a type of baptism.

Exodus 14

EXODUS & CONQUEST

Manna from Heaven

c. 1450 BC

God feeds Israel with bread from heaven in the wilderness. Jesus later reveals Himself as the true Bread of Life.

EXODUS & CONQUEST

The Ten Commandments

c. 1450 BC

God gives Moses the Law on Mount Sinai — ten commandments written by God's own finger on tablets of stone.

EXODUS & CONQUEST

The Golden Calf

c. 1450 BC

While Moses is on Sinai, the people make a golden idol. Moses intercedes for them. God punishes but does not destroy His people.

Exodus 16; John 6:31–35

Exodus 19–20

Exodus 32

EXODUS & CONQUEST

The Tabernacle Built

c. 1450 BC

God commands Moses to build a tabernacle — a dwelling place where He will meet His people. The Ark of the Covenant holds the tablets of the Law.

Exodus 25–27; 40

EXODUS & CONQUEST

The Bronze Serpent

c. 1410 BC

Poisonous serpents afflict Israel. Moses raises a bronze serpent on a pole, and all who look upon it are healed — a type of the Cross.

Numbers 21:4–9; John 3:14

EXODUS & CONQUEST

Crossing the Jordan

c. 1410 BC

Joshua leads Israel across the Jordan into the Promised Land. The waters part as the priests carry the Ark forward.

Joshua 3–4

EXODUS & CONQUEST

The Fall of Jericho

c. 1400 BC

Israel marches around Jericho for seven days. On the seventh day they shout, and the walls fall. Victory comes through faith, not force.

Joshua 6

JUDGES & KINGS

Deborah Judges Israel

c. 1200 BC

The prophetess Deborah leads Israel to victory over Sisera's army. God raises up women to deliver His people.

Judges 4–5

JUDGES & KINGS

Gideon's 300 Warriors

c. 1150 BC

God reduces Gideon's army from 32,000 to 300 so that Israel will know the victory is God's, not theirs.

Judges 7

JUDGES & KINGS

Samson's Strength

c. 1100 BC

God gives Samson supernatural strength to defend Israel. His final act of self-sacrifice defeats the Philistines.

JUDGES & KINGS

Ruth's Faithfulness

c. 1100 BC

Ruth the Moabite clings to her mother-in-law Naomi and follows her to Israel. She becomes an ancestor of King David and of Christ.

JUDGES & KINGS

Hannah's Prayer

c. 1100 BC

Hannah prays with tears for a child and vows to dedicate him to God. God grants her Samuel, who becomes a great prophet.

Judges 13–16

Ruth 1–4

1 Samuel 1

JUDGES & KINGS

Samuel Anoints Saul

c. 1050 BC

Israel demands a king like the other nations. God gives them Saul, but warns that earthly kings will fail them.

1 Samuel 8–10

JUDGES & KINGS

David and Goliath

c. 1025 BC

The young shepherd David defeats the giant Goliath with a sling and a stone, trusting not in armor but in the name of the Lord.

1 Samuel 17

JUDGES & KINGS

David Becomes King

c. 1010 BC

David is anointed king over all Israel and makes Jerusalem his capital. God promises that David's throne will last forever.

2 Samuel 5–7

JUDGES & KINGS

The Psalms of David

c. 1000 BC

David writes psalms of praise, repentance, and prophecy. The Coptic Church prays the Psalms daily in the Agpeya and before every liturgical reading.

Psalms

JUDGES & KINGS

Solomon Builds the Temple

c. 960 BC

Solomon builds the Temple in Jerusalem, and the glory of the Lord fills it. God now has a permanent dwelling among His people.

1 Kings 6–8

JUDGES & KINGS

The Kingdom Divides

c. 930 BC

After Solomon's death, the kingdom splits in two: Israel in the north and Judah in the south. Both will struggle with idolatry.

1 Kings 12

PROPHETS & EXILE

Elijah on Mount Carmel

c. 860 BC

Elijah challenges the prophets of Baal. Fire from heaven consumes his sacrifice, proving the Lord alone is God.

PROPHETS & EXILE

Elijah Taken Up

c. 850 BC

Elijah is taken to heaven in a chariot of fire. His mantle falls to Elisha, who receives a double portion of his spirit.

PROPHETS & EXILE

Jonah and the Great Fish

c. 780 BC

Jonah flees God's command and is swallowed by a great fish for three days. Jesus points to Jonah as a sign of His own burial and resurrection.

1 Kings 18

2 Kings 2:1–14

Jonah 1–2; Matthew 12:40

PROPHETS & EXILE

Isaiah's Vision

c. 740 BC

Isaiah sees the Lord enthroned, with seraphim crying “Holy, Holy, Holy!” He is cleansed and called to prophesy the coming Messiah.

Isaiah 6; 7:14; 53

PROPHETS & EXILE

The Fall of the Northern Kingdom

722 BC

Assyria conquers Israel. The ten northern tribes are scattered. Idolatry and unfaithfulness bring God's judgment.

2 Kings 17

PROPHETS & EXILE

The Three Holy Youth

c. 600 BC

Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego refuse to worship the golden image and are cast into the fiery furnace. A fourth figure appears with them.

Daniel 3

PROPHETS & EXILE

The Fall of Jerusalem

586 BC

Babylon destroys the Temple and takes Judah into exile. The prophets had warned for generations, but the people did not repent.

2 Kings 25; Jeremiah 52

PROPHETS & EXILE

Daniel in the Lions' Den

c. 540 BC

Daniel prays to God despite the king's decree and is thrown into a den of lions. God sends an angel to shut the lions' mouths.

Daniel 6

PROPHETS & EXILE

The Return from Exile

538 BC

King Cyrus of Persia allows the Jews to return to Jerusalem and rebuild the Temple. God keeps His promise to restore His people.

Ezra 1–3

PROPHETS & EXILE

The Temple Rebuilt

516 BC

Under Zerubbabel, the second Temple is completed. The elders weep, remembering Solomon's Temple, but the prophets promise greater glory to come.

PROPHETS & EXILE

Esther Saves Her People

c. 480 BC

Queen Esther risks her life to save the Jewish people from destruction. Her courage and fasting deliver an entire nation.

PROPHETS & EXILE

The Holy Family in Egypt

c. 4 BC

Fulfilling Hosea's prophecy, the Holy Family flees to Egypt. The Coptic Church celebrates this journey that blessed the land of Egypt.

Ezra 6; Haggai 2:9

Esther 4–8

Matthew 2:13–15; Hosea 11:1

THE INCARNATION

The Annunciation

c. 5 BC

The Archangel Gabriel appears to the Virgin Mary and announces she will bear the Son of God. Mary says: “Let it be to me according to your word.”

Luke 1:26–38

THE INCARNATION

The Nativity of Christ

c. 4 BC

Jesus is born in Bethlehem. Angels announce His birth to shepherds. The Magi follow a star to worship the newborn King.

Luke 2:1–20; Matthew 2:1–12

THE INCARNATION

The Baptism of Christ

c. AD 27

John baptizes Jesus in the Jordan. The Holy Spirit descends like a dove and the Father declares: “This is My beloved Son.” The Coptic feast of Epiphany celebrates this theophany.

Matthew 3:13–17

THE INCARNATION

The Temptation in the Wilderness

c. AD 27

Jesus fasts forty days and defeats Satan's temptations with the Word of God. He shows us how to resist the evil one.

Matthew 4:1–11

THE INCARNATION

The Sermon on the Mount

c. AD 28

Jesus teaches the Beatitudes and the way of the Kingdom: love your enemies, pray in secret, do not worry, build your house on rock.

Matthew 5–7

THE INCARNATION

The Transfiguration

c. AD 30

Jesus reveals His divine glory on the mountain. Moses and Elijah appear with Him. The Father's voice speaks again: “Hear Him!”

Matthew 17:1–8

THE INCARNATION

The Raising of Lazarus

c. AD 30

Jesus raises Lazarus from the dead after four days in the tomb. “I am the resurrection and the life” — a foretaste of the general resurrection.

THE INCARNATION

Palm Sunday

c. AD 30

Jesus enters Jerusalem riding a donkey. Crowds wave palm branches and cry “Hosanna!” The humble King comes in peace.

THE INCARNATION

The Last Supper

c. AD 30

Jesus shares the Passover meal with His disciples and institutes the Holy Eucharist: “This is My Body... This is My Blood.”

John 11:1–44

Matthew 21:1–11

Matthew 26:17–30; Luke 22:14–20

THE INCARNATION

The Crucifixion

c. AD 30

Jesus is crucified on Golgotha, bearing the sins of the world. He forgives His enemies and commends His spirit to the Father. The Cross becomes the Tree of Life.

Matthew 27; John 19

THE INCARNATION

The Resurrection

c. AD 30

On the third day, Christ rises from the dead! The tomb is empty. Death is conquered. "Christ is risen from the dead; by death He has trampled down death."

Matthew 28; John 20

THE INCARNATION

The Ascension

c. AD 30

Forty days after the Resurrection, Jesus ascends to heaven. He promises to send the Holy Spirit and to return in glory.

Acts 1:6–11

THE EARLY CHURCH

Pentecost

c. AD 30

The Holy Spirit descends on the apostles as tongues of fire. They preach boldly and three thousand are baptized. The Church is born.

Acts 2

THE EARLY CHURCH

The Stoning of St. Stephen

c. AD 34

Stephen, full of grace, becomes the first Christian martyr. He sees heaven open and forgives his killers, as Christ did on the Cross.

Acts 6–7

THE EARLY CHURCH

The Conversion of St. Paul

c. AD 35

Saul the persecutor meets the risen Christ on the road to Damascus and becomes Paul, the apostle to the nations.

Acts 9:1–19

THE EARLY CHURCH

St. Mark in Egypt

c. AD 49

St. Mark brings the Gospel to Alexandria and founds the Coptic Church. The faith takes root in Egypt and flourishes to this day.

THE EARLY CHURCH

The Council of Jerusalem

c. AD 50

The apostles gather to decide: must Gentile believers follow the Jewish law? The Holy Spirit guides the Church to welcome all nations.

Coptic Tradition

Acts 15

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Salvation History
Timeline

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